INDUSTRY INSIGHTS · WEEK 1

The state of private lending in 2026.

A look at the data behind the fastest-growing corner of real estate finance — and what separates the shops that scale.

SWIPE →

THE MARKET

10,136

active private lenders operating in the U.S. today — up **16% year over year**. The space isn't niche anymore. It's institutionalizing fast.

SCALE VS. PLATEAU

What separates shops that scale from shops that plateau?

One word: **predictability**. Consistent pricing, consistent process, consistent output — regardless of who's at the desk.

THE KNOWLEDGE TRAP

Knowledge that isn't transferable isn't scalable.

If your pricing logic lives in one person's head — or one analyst's spreadsheet — you've built a ceiling, not a business.

TECHNOLOGY GAP

94%

of real estate investment managers **lack advanced operational technology**. The infrastructure gap is the single biggest constraint on growth.

HOW IT ACTUALLY RUNS

Most shops run on spreadsheets and 4–6 disconnected tools.

Pricing in one place. CRM in another. LOS in a third. Investor reporting in a fourth. The seams are where deals die.

THE REAL QUESTION

The question isn't where the industry is today.

It's where you want to be in **three years** — and whether your operation can get there with the systems you have right now.

EZ RATE SHEET

Pricing is a process — not a person.

Built for private lenders who want their pricing to scale with the rest of the business.

ezratesheet.com →